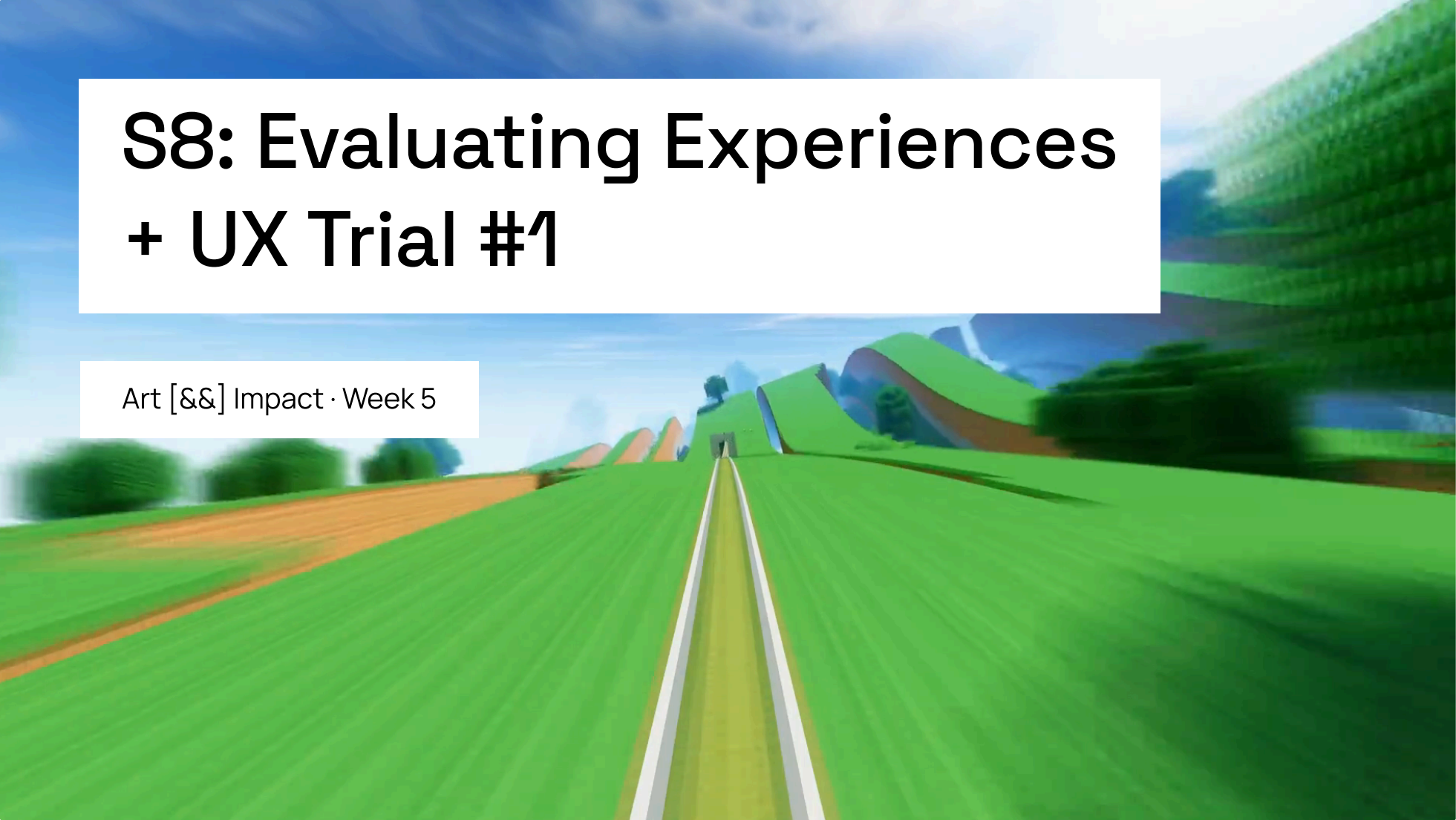


S8: Evaluating Experiences + UX Trial #1

Art [&&] Impact · Week 5



In This Session

BLOCK	CONTENT	DURATION	AI ZONE
Feedback	CRITEEC (UT) · Phase 1 Patterns	10 min	🟡 Brain-first
Lecture	Evaluating Experience · Reading the Response Getting From Trial to Insight	40 min	🟡 Brain-first
Trial Prep	Group meeting to prepare for afternoon trial	30 min	🟡 Brain-first
🍷 Lunch	—	—	—
UX Trial #1	Two audience waves + team synthesis	3.5h	🟢 No AI

*People missing or leaving early without team agreement?
Strongly consider issuing a **Yellow card** 🟡 — issued via group's Teams channel*

Where We Are

← LAST WEEK (S7)

Phase 2 Overview + Persona Workshop

GenAI Personas · Design Questions ·
Statement → Design Question
translation

 TODAY (S8)

Evaluating Experiences + UX Trial #1

Evaluating experience · Reading the
response · From trial to insight

First UX trial

→ NEXT (S9)

Interactive Systems

Experience Specification · Track-
specific I/O · Inclusive design
Restrictions & Logistics

What you need to build your concept

 **Today is still conceptual.** Practical questions—space, materials, what's buildable—are entering the picture next week!

Today is about resolving open questions about your concept!

CRITEEC (UT) + Phase 1 Patterns

Responding to your feedback · Notes about your Phase 1 submissions

Responding to the Critique

CONCEPT BEFORE CONSTRUCTION

We're holding back the building phase. It's CreaTers' comfy place; but difficult to later on infuse with meaning.

Conceptual design is HARD; even if the result can look easy

Success is not having each activity completed as fast as possible; but trying your best to see if the approach helps

Different activities help different people!

Phase 1: Big Picture Feedback

What Went Well

- Conceptual ambition; some really interesting positions
- Restatable statements; many clear one-sentence claims
- Confident delivery

What to Work On

- Authorship often absent or thin
- Positions are too safe or stated as questions (afraid to commit?)
- Audiences too generic to design for
- Tech rationale often not argued in relation to concept
- Portfolio looks like course work

Check MS Teams for a link to previous portfolios for inspiration!

Design Question Analysis

“Does this ever-evolving installation produce a feeling of belonging?”

→ **Effect without cause.**

What does “ever-evolving” look like?
Peers can’t respond to an effect they can’t picture.

“Does [activity] produce a sense of societal/technological reduction of our identity?”

→ **Target too abstract.** “Reduction of identity” – what does that look like for a person? Is it observable?

“Does exposing visitors to their own sounds and visual appearance produce discomfort towards themselves?”

→ **Missing the link.** Specific and concrete – but what is the discomfort in service of? Trace it back to the statement.

*For this afternoon: look for opportunities to improve your question
But also: really use the time for actual trialing!*

Personas as Tools

The tools from S7 are reusable—use them if the situation calls for it.

SHARPENING YOUR QUESTION

The **Naïve Audience Member** reveals whether your question makes sense without background.

The **Critical Art Critic** checks whether it traces back to your statement.

RESOLVING TEAM TENSION

Working through direction conflicts before this afternoon? The **Intra-Team Mediator** might be worth a try.

Not a requirement — a resource! Linked on Canvas.

Evaluating Experience

You can only evaluate what you've made explicit!

Make Intentions Explicit

THE PROBLEM

“People should feel something” is not an intention.

If you can't describe the emotional experience clearly enough to describe it — you can't evaluate whether it happened.

“We intend for the visitor to **feel brief guilt**; aware they've caused something, and **uncertain whether they want to undo** it.”

Intended quality → designed cause → observable test

EXPERIENCE MAP AS TOOL (FROM D4E)

You mapped the emotional journey before the trial.

This becomes a benchmark: **what visitors report gets compared against what you expected.**

Catches incoherences! If your design decisions don't support the journey you've drawn, you've identified a need for changing your design.

Not based on a single individual experience, but when emerging as a pattern!

You can only evaluate what you've stated clearly enough to test!

What Counts as Evidence?

✓ USEFUL

- What visitors say **before** you explain.
- Similar responses **appearing across multiple visitors**.
- What they 'misunderstood' – and how?
- Any response you can compare against your intended emotional response or experience journey.

✗ LESS USEFUL

- *"I liked it."*
- Responses **after** you explained the concept.
- Single outliers with no pattern.

🔗 THE TEST

Does this response tell you whether your **design question** has an answer – or whether your **intended journey** happened? If yes to either – it's evidence. If no – it's still feedback, but not evaluation data!

Four Signs Your Design Question Needs Tweaking

🎯 EMOTIONAL TARGET TOO ABSTRACT

"A sense of self-awareness" – what does that look like?

Fix: get the target down to something observable:

"a visitor pauses, glances at their own reflection or trace, and adjusts their behavior"

❓ EFFECT DESCRIBED WITHOUT CAUSE

Peers can't respond to *"does this ever-evolving installation produce belonging"* if they don't know what *ever-evolving* looks like.

Fix: ground the question in something concrete – a sketch, a scenario, a rough diagram.

CCC Groups: Two Locations

One coordination decision before you start.

You have two testing locations. That means a choice:

- **Test the same question in both places** — compare responses across contexts
- **Split and test different aspects** — cover more ground

Either is valid, but decide now — not during the trial!

Reading the Response

Not all feedback means the same thing

“I Didn’t Understand It” can mean ...

❌ CONCEPT FAILURE

The concept genuinely isn’t understandable. Something about the design or the idea itself doesn’t communicate.

Fix: rethink the concept or the interaction.

🗨️ COMMUNICATION FAILURE

The concept or interaction is legible — but the framing wasn’t. A presentation problem, not a concept problem.

Fix: change how you present, not what you made.

💡 UNEXPECTED RESONANCE

The visitor understood something different from what you intended — and that something different might be more interesting than your original plan.

Sit with it before you fix it.

The third case can be a source of surprise and inspiration!

But make sure it’s actual surprise; not leaving up the design to the audience

From Trial to Insight

Turn what you heard into a decision

Method: Feedback Cards First!

Capture unprompted reaction first—written immediately, before a team fills in details.

More evaluation tools coming up in D4E Week 6.
Think about this session when you hear about them!

WHAT VISITORS WRITE DOWN

“What did you observe, what’s unclear, and what’s one thing you’d push further?”

Noted down as three fields:

- **Observation** — what you understood
- **Question** — what’s unclear or unresolved
- **‘What if...’** — one suggestion framed as a question

*One card per visitor per team visited.
Be specific! Generic encouragement is not useful.*

*Want to discuss or go more in detail?
Do it after your visitor has filled in a card!*

From Cards to Decision

- 1. Read alone first** — before discussing as a team, each person reads the cards and marks what surprised them.
- 2. Look for repetition** — the same observation appearing across multiple visitors is a signal, not noise.
- 3. What happened?** — look for concept failure, communication failure, or unexpected resonance?
- 4. Make a decision** — what will you change, and why? Doesn't need to be perfect; but don't leave without a plan!

UX Trial Report Format (at the end of the session)

1 · QUESTION TESTED

What specific design question was this trial investigating?

2 · METHOD USED

How did you try to answer it? What did you observe or ask?

3 · FINDING

What did you actually observe or hear?

4 · CHANGE MADE

What did you decide to do differently as a result?

Report these in your Notion Portfolio! Sketches, visuals, words ...

UX Trial Schedule

TIME	BLOCK
14:00–15:00	Trial Wave 1
15:00–15:30	Analysis · Quick Changes · Swap Groups
15:30–16:30	Trial Wave 2
16:30–17:00	Team Synthesis · Trial Report

- Half of the group showcases and runs the trial
- The other half visits trials from other groups
- **Everyone should have trialed for every other group**

Trial Prep

Group meeting to prepare for afternoon trial

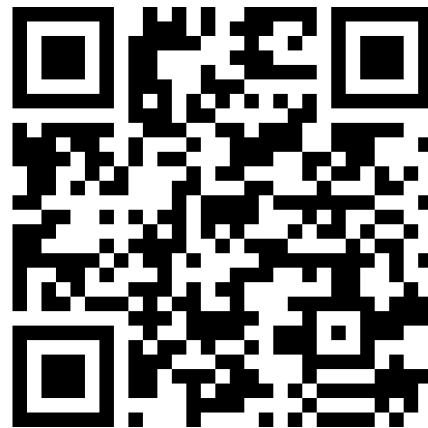
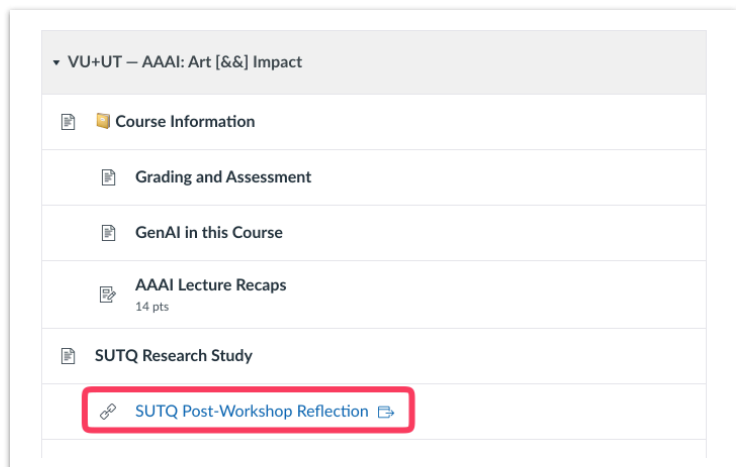
 Brain-first

 Until Lunch

SUTQ Persona Feedback

Recall your **experience of the GenAI Persona Workshop**.
Share your thoughts!

You can find the link also on Canvas!



SUTQ: Workshop Survey

*Looking also for people who would share
their opinion in an interview / focus group!*

Lunch

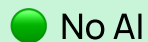
BEFORE THE AFTERNOON

- Set up a testing space – table or cluster of chairs
- Have design materials ready: sketches, diagrams, storyboards, scenarios
- CCC groups: confirm your two-location approach

UX Trial #1

UX Trial #1: Two Waves + Synthesis

First wave starts at 14:00 —prepare your trial until we start!



No AI



3.5h

Trial Wave 1

14:00–15:00

Half your group stays and trials – the other half visits other teams

FEEDBACK CARD

*“What did you observe, what’s unclear,
and what’s one thing you’d push further?”*

- **Observation** – what you saw and understood
- **Question** – what’s unclear or unresolved
- **What if...** – one thing you’d push further

60:00

Start

Edit

*Want to discuss or go more in detail?
Do it after your visitor has filled in a card!*

Synthesis + Swap

15:00–15:30

- Look for patterns on the cards you collected
- Make notes about *what landed, and what didn't*.
- If useful: implement small changes to modify your trial
- Then swap who of the group trials

30:00



Start

Edit

Trial Wave 2

15:30–16:30

Half your group stays and trials – the other half visits other teams

FEEDBACK CARD

*“What did you observe, what’s unclear,
and what’s one thing you’d push further?”*

- **Observation** – what you saw and understood
- **Question** – what’s unclear or unresolved
- **What if...** – one thing you’d push further

60:00

Start

Edit

*Want to discuss or go more in detail?
Do it after your visitor has filled in a card!*

Team Synthesis

16:30–17:00

- Read all your cards together and synthesize **before** any AI tools.
- Write one report entry: **question tested · method · finding · what you think you'll change**
- Report goes into your Notion portfolio as UX Trial #1

30:00



Start

Edit

Art [88] Impact

See you at S9 – Week 6, Thursday!